From “It Works” to a Written List

Nine steps for reviewing Mom's support at your family's pace, with a line for who takes each one and when.

The goal: what Mom gets help with, who does it, who else could, and what's still an open question are all on one written list that Mom and the family have seen.

There's no deadline on this. Share the list, put a name beside each step, add a date only where a date helps, and tick each one when it's done.

ACTION	WHO	BY WHEN	DONE
1. Gather what the family already has about Mom's week: earlier notes, a list someone started, anything a professional has written that she's chosen to share. If there's nothing yet, start with a blank page.			
2. With Mom, list what she gets help with in an ordinary week, one thing to a line: the rides, the bills, the evening call and the smaller things.			
3. Beside each line, write who does it now and how often.			
4. Beside each line, write who else could do it, and whether that person has been asked. Use “only them,” “agreed” or “assumed.”			
5. Where two of you remember an arrangement differently, or nobody knows, write both versions or “don't know,” with who said what.			
6. Add the parts of Mom's week that aren't chores: who she sees, the things she likes to do, and who tells whom when a plan changes.			
7. Ask each person who helps how their part fits with the rest of their week. Write the answer as they give it.			
8. Write any question about Mom's health or her medications as a question, with who it goes to: her doctor or her pharmacist. Change nothing.			
9. Sort the open lines into “open today” and “might come up later,” put a name beside each one for who will follow it up, and agree what would bring the family back to the list.			

You're done when

The family has one written list that Mom has seen, with what's open today kept apart from what might come up later, a name beside each open line, and an agreed reason to look at it again: a date, or a change in someone's routine. Going over that list with a professional, and any change to Mom's week, isn't on this plan. That part belongs to Mom and to the professionals who know her.

If a step stalls

- “Only them,” “assumed” and “don't know” are finished lines. Don't fill one with a guess, or with the name of someone who hasn't been asked.
- If Mom would rather not go through it today, pick it up on another visit. It's her week.
- If someone says they can't be a backup, write that down as they said it and thank them. It's an answer.
- The order helps, and nothing here has a due date. Skip a step that's stuck and come back to it.

What this plan doesn't do

It organizes the family's part. Finishing it doesn't certify that Mom's arrangement is safe or sufficient, and it doesn't authorize any change to her care or her medications. It gets you ready for a professional review; it isn't one.

Ready for the next step?

You've taken “it works” out of everyone's heads and put it on one list, a step at a time. The care interview goes through Mom's daily life area by area with you, including the parts that are fine today, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

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